



Instantly create a logo in Gimp

Create a logo

To create a logo, or a text with effects such as word art, go to **File > Create > LOGOS** and choose one of the options from the list. Enter the text for the logo in the Text: field. Change the font and background colour, and increase the font size as necessary. Click on **Ok**. The logo created will typically be a composite of a few layers. Select the topmost layer and go to **Layer > Merge Down** to merge the layer with the layers below it. Merge all but the last layer to create a logo with transparency.

Change layer composition

The blending options for layers is located in the Mode drop down box of the layer toolbox. The regular options available up to Photoshop CS3 are available. To fade changes to a degree with blending options, once changes are made, go to **Edit > Fade**, then use the transparency slider and blending options.

Working with layers

There is no pointer available in the toolbox,

which is strange. While it is possible to drag and drop images to open them in Gimp, it is not possible to drag and drop images onto a layer. Select all, copy then paste into the file to create a layer. Use the scale tool to resize an image once it is dragged into a layer. Once you have rescaled an image, click on **Scale** to finalise the scaling. Alternatively, you can go to **Layer > Scale Layer**. You also cannot drag a layer to re-arrange the layer order. Go to **Layer > Stack > Raise Layer** or **Layer > Stack > Lower Layer** for rearranging layers. An interesting option not available in Photoshop is to reverse the order of layers. Go to **Layer > Stack > Reverse Layer Order**. The visible order of the layers remain the same, but the top to bottom or bottom to top interpretation of the layer order switches every time you reverse the layer order.

Selection

Apart from making sure that a layer is selected, you always have to have the entire image selected to work on it. If the whole image or a part of it is not selected, you cannot perform any photo editing operations at all. The best tools to select a part of the image is the Fuzzy Select tool, which is similar to the Magic Wand in Photoshop, and the Lasso select tool. The lasso tool offers bigger circular nodes, which is an advantage over Photoshop.

Using the clone tool

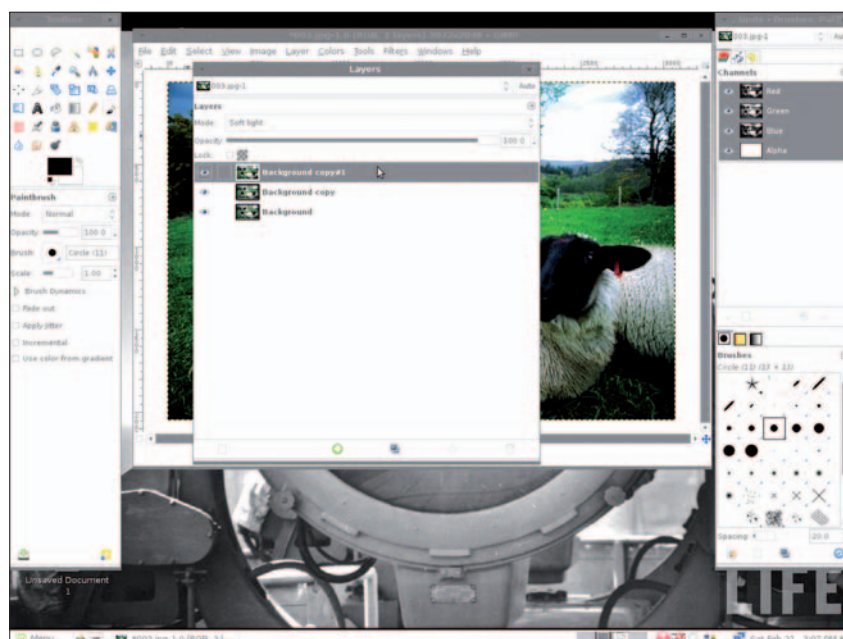
The clone tool can be used to hide unwanted artefacts or cover up unwanted features. What the clone tool does, is lift a portion of an image, and impose it over another portion of the image. To select the reference portion of the image, hold **[Ctrl]** and click on the part of the image you want to use as the reference. Then, use the clone tool over the area of the image you want to cover up. For elements such as fences or walls, you can use the perspective clone tool.

Use a smaller menu

By default, the menu and toolboxes of Gimp are pretty large. You can reduce the size by going to **Edit > Preferences > Theme > Small**. This step will also free up more space for the image window. Go to **Edit > Preferences > Interface > User Interface**. Change the Default layer and channel size to "Small" and Navigation preview size to "Small".

Correcting the white balance

If you have taken images with the wrong white balance, you can fix them automatically in Gimp. Go to **Colors > Auto > White Balance**, and Gimp should take care of the rest.



Changing the composition of layers